

Board 1

South Deals

None Vul

♠ Q J 10 8
 ♥ Q 10 5 4 2
 ♦ 7 3
 ♣ A 3

♠ 9 7 5
 ♥ J 7
 ♦ K Q 8
 ♣ K J 9 8 2



♠ K 6 2
 ♥ K 6 3
 ♦ 9 5 4 2
 ♣ 7 6 5

♠ A 4 3
 ♥ A 9 8
 ♦ A J 10 6
 ♣ Q 10 4

<i>West</i>	<i>North</i>	<i>East</i>	<i>South</i>
Pass	3NT		1NT
All Pass			
3NT by South			

The bidding has been as shown. The contract is 3NT

Lead the ♥4.

This is a close call. The top of your ♠ honor sequence is very tempting, but even when you find partner with the ♠K you can still only establish three ♠ winners to go with your ♣A. Unfortunately, that's not enough to defeat the contract.

Leading a ♥ from your 5-card suit is riskier, but it has the potential of setting up an additional winner. In this hand, as you see, the ♥ lead gets you 4 ♥ winners to go with your ♣A.

Board 3

South Deals

None Vul

♠ 8 4
 ♥ 9 8 2
 ♦ A 10 5 3
 ♣ A J 6 2

♠ K J 7 5

♥ A K 6 5

♦ 8 7 4 2

♣ 5



♠ Q 10 6 2

♥ 10

♦ Q J 9 6

♣ Q 10 9 3

♠ A 9 3

♥ Q J 7 4 3

♦ K

♣ K 8 7 4

West	North	East	South
			1 ♥
Pass	1 ♠	Pass	2 ♣
Pass	4 ♥		
All Pass			
4 ♥ by South			

The bidding has been as shown. The contract is 4 ♥

Underleading an Ace against a suit contract is the absolute worst opening lead in Bridge. A careful look at this hand shows just how bad it can turn out.

And leading from a doubleton in a suit the opponents have bid is almost as bad.

So by process of elimination you lead a trump, probably the ♥9.

And when South plays ♣s, (preparing to ruff in dummy), you will win and play another trump. Even if South guesses the ♠s correctly he will not be able to make the contract.